PORTFOLIO 2026



DENNIS GRASSI

SPATIAL NARRATIVES

THROUGH MATTER,

LIGHT AND ATMOSPHERE

SELECTED WORKS IN INTERIOR

RETAIL AND PRODUCT DESIGN

MASTER APPLICATION
INTERIOR DESIGN

IUAV VENEZIA

THROUGH

TRASPARENCY AS A LIVING MATERIAL

Bachelor Thesis
Decoration & Interior Design
LABA Brescia

THROUGH investigates trasparency as a perceptive and sapcial condition rather than a purely aesthetic quality.

The research originates from the study of the **light and space movment** and the work of **Sabine Marcelis,** both fundamental references for understanding how **light** can **define matter,** atmosphere and perception.

Through translucent, reflective and smoked materials,
the project explores the relationship between light diffusion, depth and visual presence.
Ttrasparency becomes an active medium:
not only something to look throught, but material capable of **transforming light into structure.**

the collection develops a family of objects where resin interacts with travertine, corten steel and reflective surfaces, creating contrasts between opacity and luminosity, softness and desinity.

GENESIS represents the luminous origin og the collection: a table lamp conceived as a solid volume crossed by light, where illumination is embedded with the material itself and becomes part of the object's physical identity.



GENESIS

The luminous origin of the collection.

MATERIAL LANGUAGE

TRANSLUCENT RESIN
Light diffusion / soft shadows



SMOKED RESIN
Depth and visual density



TRAVERTINE
Natural opacity/ mineral texture



CORTEN STEEL
Oxidized reflection and contrast



REFLECTIVE RESIN
Internal light amplification



COATED METAL
Structural precision

RESEARCH & INSPIRATION

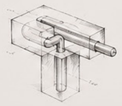
Sabine Marcelis - Light and spacee Movement







The research is rooted in the exploration of light.as a perceptive and spatial phenomenon. Artists and designers of the Light and Space movement, along with the work of Sabine Marcelis, have been fundamental references for understanding the expressive potential of light and matter.



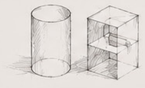
LIGHT INTERACTION
Relationship between ligh and translucent surfaces.



LIGHT DIFFUSION
Softening and spreading of the light within matter.



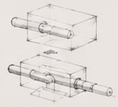
MATERIAL LAYERING
Combination of transparent and reflective materials



FORM EXPLORATION
Study of volume, proportion and visual weight.



STRUCTURAL LOGIC
Clarity of components and internal structure,



ASSEMBLY SYSTEM
Simple connections for a fluid and coherent design.

THROUGH

COLLECTION OVERVIEW

FILTRED
COFFE TABLE



LOW.KEY
TABLE



HIGH.KEY
TABLE



HALO
SUSPENSION LAMP



BENT.IN
CHAIR



PLINTH
SIDE TABLE / PEDESTAL



STILL.SIT
ARMCHAIR



QB
RIGID POUF



SETTING CONCEPT

ONE SPACE, THREE ATMOSPHERES

Bachelor Thesis
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The setting is conceived as a single continuous space, symbolically divided into three interconnected areas.

A neutral and essential scenography enhances the products, allowing their materials, proportions and presence to speak.

The balance between architecture, light and matter creates a silent dialogue that adapts to different scenarios and contexts.







THE LOUNGE

a space for conversation and contemplation.

THE STAGE

a central focus for curated experience

THE DINING HALL

a setting for sharing and connection.

PROCESS

The setting is conceived as a continuous open environment where material, light and spatial flow generate three interconnected atmospheres.

The arrangement encourages movement, dialogue and contemplation, creating a balance between intimacy and openness.

01 - LAYOUT STUDY



LOUNGE STAGE DINING

– MAIN FLOW ── SECONDARY FLOW ┄┄ VISUAL CONNECTION

02 - SPATIAL RHYTHM



03 - LIGHT SCENARIO



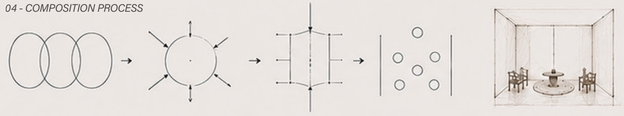
SOFT → FOCUS → AMBIENT







04 - COMPOSITION PROCESS



three functions one continuous space

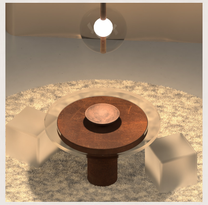
movement towards a central focus

vertical elements define the center

furniture placement according to use

FINAL ATMOSPHERE AND PROPORTION

05 - MATERIAL & ATMOSPHERE









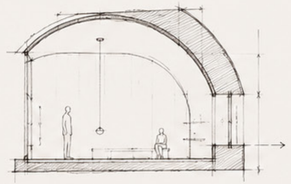
JIL SANDER - RETAIL SPACE

MILAN, ITALY

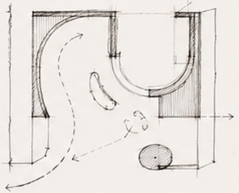
CONCEPT

The project explores a retail environment defined by continuity, material tactility and spatial fluidity.
Curved geometries guide movement through a sequence of intimate atmospheres.

SPATIAL STUDIES



1. SECTION STUDY
Exploration of proportions and vertical relationships.



2. SPATIAL SEQUENCING
Definition of the path and the experiential flow.



3. VOLUMES AND MATERIALITY
Study of volumes, surfaces and their interaction.

MATERIAL PALETTE



TRAVERTINE | NATURAL STONE SLATS | SATIN STEEL | TEXTURED PLASTER | TRASPARENT GLASS | OLIVE GREEN VELVET

DESIGN PROCESS

01 — Analysis of the brand identity and spatial values.

02 — Definition of the volumes and spatial organization.

03 — Material and surface research.

04 — Integration of display systems and functional elements.

05 — Atmospheric and lighting studies.

06 — Final spatial composition

ATMOSPHERE



POETICS OF SPACE

Space does not impose.
It guides quietly.
Matter shapes perception, defining boundaries without separating.

Light reveals textures, proportions and depth, creating an intimate atmosphere.

Every element is reduced to its essential presence, in dialogue with the identity of Jil Sander.

A space designed through balance, materiality and silence.

FINAL SPACE







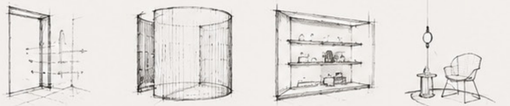


DETAILS & MATERIALITY



A RETAIL SPACE DESIGNED FOR TIMELESSNESS, WHERE MATERIALITY, PROPORTION AND LIGHT CREATE A QUIET AND INTIMATE EXPERIENCE.

LIGHT & ATMOSPHERE



NATURAL LIGHT
Large openings enhance materiality and depth.

ARTIFICIAL LIGHT
Integrated lighting creates soft and intimate atmospheres.

LIGHT ON MATERIALS
Grazing light emphasizes textures and details.

ATMOSPHERIC FOCUS
Light directs attention and guides the experience.

CATmouflage

CONCEPT & PHILOSOPHY

Catmouflage is a pouf-container designed to adapt to your cat and to your home.
When closed, it is a refined pouf with a compact and seamless shape.

When opened, the lid reveals a soft fur sack that wraps around your cat, offering a safe, hidden and comforting space.

The lid, thanks to its feet, becomes a mini pouf on its own.

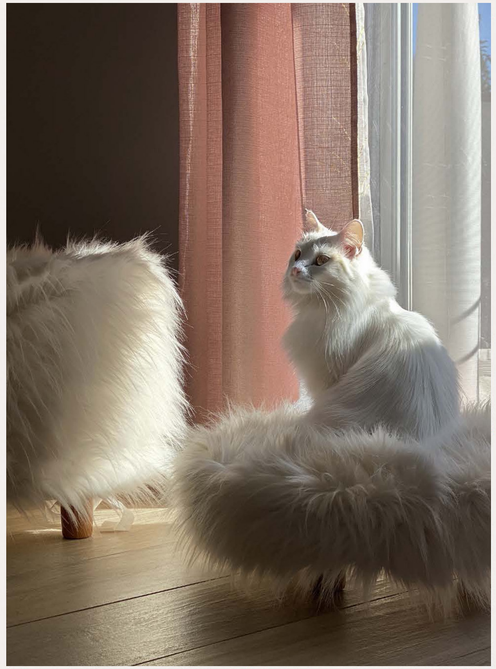
the fur sack wraps around
Transformable, removable and customisable, it respects your cat's nature and simplifies everyday life at home.

KEY CONCEPTS

01 - ADAPT
designed to adapt to your cat

02 - TRANSFORM
from safe container to pouf / footstool

03 - DISAPPEAR
the cat disappears and feels protected

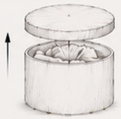


HOW IT WORKS



01 - CLOSED

compact and seamless shape, without openings or interruptions.



02 - LID REMOVED

the lid is removed easily, revealing the fur sack.



03 - CAT SACK REVEALED

the fur sack wraps around the cat, offering a hidden space of safety and comfort



04 - LID AS MINI POUF

the lid, with its feet, becomes a mini pouf, footstool or low seat.

TRANSFORMATION



MADE FOR YOUR CAT



Every cat has its habits, its measures, its way of resting. Catmouflage adapts to them all, not the other way around. Size, fur type, colours and fabrics can be chosen to create tho perfect space for your cat.

CUSTOMISABLE FURS



Different fur types and colours to suit your cat and your style.

CUSTOMISABLE SIZES

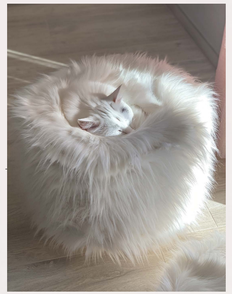


Choose the perfect size for your cat's comfort.



DESIGN & RELATIONSHIP

Catmouflage is designed to strengthen the bond between you and your cat.
It allows your cat to feel safe and embraced, while giving you a new way to observe, connect and share quiet moments.
The raised lid, with its little feet, transforms into a mini seat, bringing you closer to your cat at eye level.
A simple gesture that turns everyday life into connection.







DETAILS THAT MAKE THE DIFFERENCE



ECO-FUR OUTER COVER
soft, warm and durable



INNER FUR SACK
removable, enveloping and ultra comfortable.



REMOVABLE COVER
fully removable and washable.



WOODEN FEET
natural and stable, for both pouf and lid.



LID WITH FEET
turns into a mini seat or footstool.



STRUCTURED BODY
strong, dimensionally stable and long-lasting.

THE PERFECT VIEW

The elevated design lets you and your cat enjoy a special eye-level connection.



CUSTOMISABLE COLOURS & FABRICS



A wide selection of eco-furs and fabrics in colours that suit your cat and your home.

MORE THAN A POUF



The inner sack can be removed, leaving a practical storage space for blankets, cushions, toys and more.
The lid becomes a mini seat, footstool or extra surface.

MADELEINE VIONNET MUSEUM

PARIS, FRANCE

CONCEPT

The project translates Madeleine Vionnet's timeless language into space. Inspired by classical drapery, Greek silhouettes and fluid construction techniques, the museum transforms fashion into architecture. Marble, gold reflections and soft curved geometries create a contemporary temple dedicated to timeless elegance.

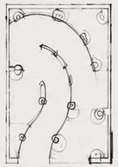
SPATIAL STUDIES

1. DRAPED GEOMETRIES



The architecture is shaped by draped lines and soft folds translating fabric into form.

2. PROCESSION & MOVEMENT



A fluid sequence of spaces guides visitors through an elevated and contemplative experience.

3. TEMPLES & DISPLAY



Sculptural displays and monumental forms create a sacred language of fashion.



MATERIALS



MARBLE — GOLD METAL — RESIN — WARM FABRIC — SATIN REFLECTIONS — SOFT LIGHTNING

POETICS OF SPACE

The museum is conceived as an immesrive sequence of spaces, where architecture becomes a tribute to Madeleine Vionnet's vision of timeless beauty. Visitors move through sculptural rooms where fashion becomes monument and form is elevated to a state of art. Light, material and proportion work together to create an atmosphere of contemplation, grace and eternity.



LIGHT AND ATMOSPHERE

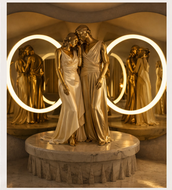


DETAILS THAT MAKE THE DIFFERENCE



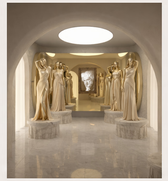
SCULPTURAL DISPLAYS

Elevated pedestals highlight the silhouette and the drape as art.



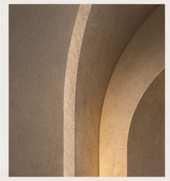
REFLECTION & DIALOGUE

Mirrors and light create a dialogue between form, reflection and space.



SEQUENTIAL EXPERIENCE

A fluid spatial sequence guides visitors through moments of discovery.



ARCHED GEOMETRIES

Soft curves and arches define the architectural language.

DISPLAY PEDESTALS



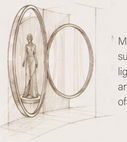
Pedestals elevate the garments, creating a sacred relationship between body, form and space.

ARCHED OPENINGS



Arches create rhythm and continuity, recalling classical architecture and temple spaces.

REFLECTION SYSTEM



Mirrors and golden surfaces multiply light and presence, amplifying the beauty of the forms

LIGHT AS SCENOGRAPHY



Natural and artificial light shape the space like a stage, enhancing materiality and emotion.

ACADEMY INSTALLATION
GRAPHIC LANDSCAPE

LABA BRESCIA

CONCEPT

The installation was developed for an internal university competition focused on creating a low-cost, high-impact intervention for shared spaces.

The proposal was selected for its feasibility, simple construction and the possibility of being assembled directly by students using accessible materials and basic fabrication techniques.

The graphic composition transforms a plain wall into a recognizable landmark through depth, rhythm and color.

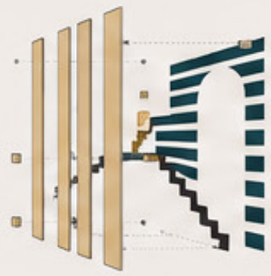
GRAPHIC CONSTRUCTION

1. WALL GRAPHICS



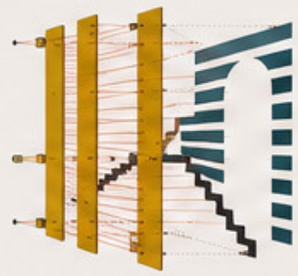
The geometric composition is first painted directly onto the existing wall, creating the graphic background.

2. WOODEN PANELS



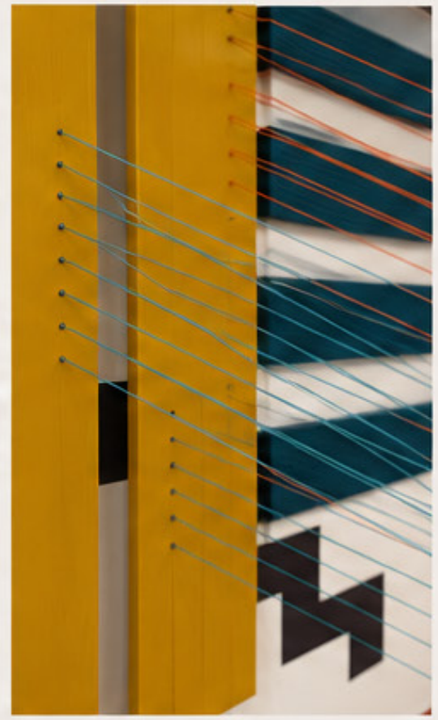
Painted MDF panels are fixed to the wall with spacers, generating different levels and shadows.

3. TENSIONED TEXTILE THREADS



Colored textile threads, matching the panel colors, are stretched between small nails fixed into the wooden elements. The threads create a lightweight three-dimensional layer that changes with light and movement.







MATERIAL SYSTEM



PAINTED MDF PANELS



COLORED TEXTILE THREADS



STEEL NAILS



WALL PAINT



HIDDEN WALL SPACERS

DESIGN PROCESS

RESEARCH
Analysis of the common areas and user experience.

GRAPHIC LANGUAGE
Development of a geometric composition inspired by architecture and perspective.

LAYERED CONSTRUCTION
Wall painting followed by wooden panels mounted on spacers.

TEXTILE NETWORK
Colored threads are tensioned between nails, creating visual depth and lightness.

LOW-COST FABRICATION
Simple materials and manuel assembly reduce production costs.

STUDENT INSTALLATION
The project was designed to be entirely assembled inside the university by students.

COLLABORATIVE CONSTRUCTION

The installation was conceived not only as a design proposal, but also as an educational experience.

Its simple construction system allowed students to participate directly through dedicated workshops, where they assembled the installation, earned academic credits and developed practical skills in fabrication, collaboration and project management.

RESULT

- LOW-COST PRODUCTION
- STUDENT-BUILT INSTALLATION
- ACADEMIC WORKSHOPS
- HANDS-ON LEARNING
- PERMANENT INTERVENTION FOR THE UNIVERSITY





